

engaging the community. We will take a look at the current state of the Bitcoin phenomenon in India as well as its potential.

Bitcoin Conference

The level of interest over Bitcoin in India reached such high levels that a Bitcoin Conference was organised where active parties and curious individuals could gather. Titled as - The Global Bitcoin Conference - it was organised in Bangalore by CoinMonk Ventures. The conference was divided into two days - first for socialising and the second for panel discussions where 20 speakers from various backgrounds discussed Bitcoin and its various aspects.

In addition to the panel discussion the conference also had participant booths that promoted and educated attendees about various new products and technologies related to Bitcoin. The booths ranged from CoinMonk's own booth that sold gold coins with the Bitcoin symbol on it, as well as selling physical Bitcoins. They also demonstrated how Bitcoin mining takes place.

The other booths present dealt with three key areas of Bitcoin - mining, trading and alternatives. The areas on trading included presentations by BTC Robot and Bitcoinex.in that are automated trading tools and Bitcoin exchanges respectively. In addition to which there were informative booths that talked about Laxmicoin the highly anticipated Indian version of Bitcoin that was expected to be launched soon.

The panels were divided into four key areas of discussion - Bitcoin and decentralisation, mining and security, Bitcoin trading, and Bitcoin regulations, trends and altcoins. The discussions placed various individuals from specialised fields together to present their viewpoints on the issues. The conference brought together bankers, technologists, cryptographers and business' as they presented their arguments in favor of Bitcoin for the Indian audience.

This conference was definitely one sided which isn't uncommon for a gathering of this type - privately organised, agenda driven and meant to convert as many people to the cause as possible. The main promises made were based around the immense potential Bitcoin has towards personal profit making. This point in specific is very much against the intended purpose of the Bitcoin philosophy. As a currency Bitcoin is intended to free people from extra costs and make transactions more convenient and trustworthy, however by advocating for short-term profit in trading, it is unlikely that the currency would find an easy acceptance in the broader marketplace. Speculative trading on Bitcoins, which is what was significantly highlighted at the conference, weakens the overall potential of Bitcoin finding stability